GIFT(S) OF THE SPIRIT

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I. Greek Terminology for Giving

A. δίδωμι: Acts **2**:4, 19; **8**:18; **14**:3; **15**:8; Romans **5**:5, *etc*.
B. μεταδίδωμι: Romans **1**:11; **12**:8
C. δόμα: Ephesians **4**:8
D. δωρεά: John **4**:10; Acts **2**:38; **10**:45; **11**:17; Ephesians **4**:7; Hebrews **6**:4
E. μερισμός: Hebrews **2**:4
F. χάρισμα: Romans **1**:11; **12**:6; 1 Corinthians **1**:7; **7**:7; **12**:4, 9, 28, 30, 31; 2 Corinthians **1**:11; 1 Timothy **4**:14; 2 Timothy **1**:6; 1 Peter **4**:10

Several other words translated "give/gift" are not used in reference to the Holy Spirit: ἀποδίδωμι, διαδίδωμι, ἐπιδίδωμι, παραδίδωμι, δωρέομαι (2 Peter **1**:3? but no clear usages of Holy Spirit), δώρημα, ἀνάθημα, ἀπονέμω, χάρις χαρίζομαι, χορηγέω, δῶρον (used of salvation in Ephesians **2**:8, but no usages of Holy Spirit).

II. Application to Holy Spirit Matters

A. The relationship/state/situation with the Spirit

1. The original sending of the Spirit: John **7**:39; Acts **2**:1 ff.
2. The right to become sons of God: John **1**:12
3. The salvation status as given: Acts **11**:18; Ephesians **2**:8
4. The gift of the Holy Spirit to individuals: Acts **2**:38; 1 John **3**:24

B. Results that come (a person's response to influence): 1 Corinthians **3**:6 (*"God gives the increase"*)

C. Acts done by individuals ("allow"): Daniel **2**:36-38; 1 Kings **12**:15; John 5:26; **6**:65; **19**:10-11; Revelation **7**:2; **9**:5; **13**:5, 7

D. Slots of service among God's people: 1 Corinthians **12**:28a; Ephesians **4**:7, 11 (means "slots" because of the word *till*)

E. Persons filling the slots: Acts **20**:28 ("made"); 2 Corinthians **10**:8 (=**13**:10); Colossians **4**:17 (*"ministry I received"*); 1 Timothy **4**:14; 2 Timothy **1**:6

F. Abilities to accomplish the tasks in these slots (lists of gifts of the Spirit: Romans **12**:6-8; 1 Corinthians **12**:28-30; Ephesians **4**:7-11)

1. Natural abilities: Matthew **19**:11 + 12; 1 Corinthians **7**:5-7 ("continence")
2. Developed skills: Acts **4**:29 ("boldness")
3. Supernatural endowments: Acts **8**:20; **10**:45; **11**:17; 1 Corinthians **12**:28b

G. Activities to be performed: 1 Corinthians **12**

III. A Proposal Regarding Gifts of the Spirit

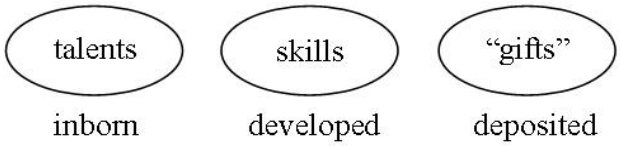
Everything a person is able to do or enabled to do is a gift of the Spirit.

A. Lists of gifts of the Spirit: Romans **12**:6-8; 1 Corinthians **12**:28-30; Ephesians **4**:7-11

B. A natural ability or developed skill becomes a gift of the Spirit when it comes under the Spirit's influence.

C. Weaknesses of the traditional view

TRADITIONAL VIEW

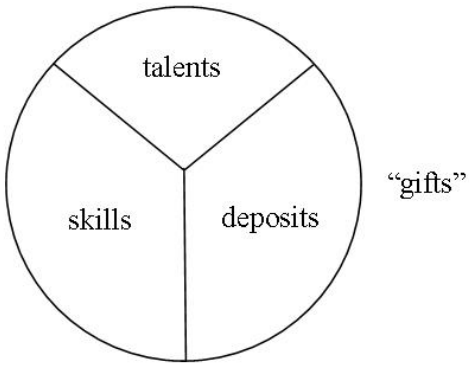


In the traditional view the word *gift* is associated with directly and supernaturally deposited capacities.

1. It encourages <u>waiting</u>.
2. It encourages <u>self-justification for not doing something</u>.
3. It encourages <u>false expectations</u>, which brings doubt about a person's relationship to God and opens a person up to false teachers and misguidance.
4. It encourages <u>misinterpretation of something as a supernatural gift</u> with the implication of unreal certainty and insusceptibility to correction from other Christians.

D. Strengths of the proposed view

PROPOSED VIEW



1. There is both a <u>sense of assistance</u> and <u>a sense of responsibility</u>.
2. A person can <u>take no credit</u> for succeeding or <u>cast no blame</u> on the Spirit for failure.
3. Everybody has something to do because <u>everybody has a gift</u>.
4. The proposed view <u>affirms people</u> as God made them.